

Words ending in -e or -y

WORDS ENDING IN -E OR -Y OFTEN CHANGE THEIR SPELLINGS WHEN A SUFFIX IS ADDED.

The final -e in words is usually silent. If a suffix is added, the -e is sometimes dropped. A final -y sometimes changes to an *i* when a suffix is added.

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◀ 132-133 Consonant sounds

◀ 140-141 Roots

◀ 142-143 Prefixes and suffixes

Silent letters

160-161 ▶

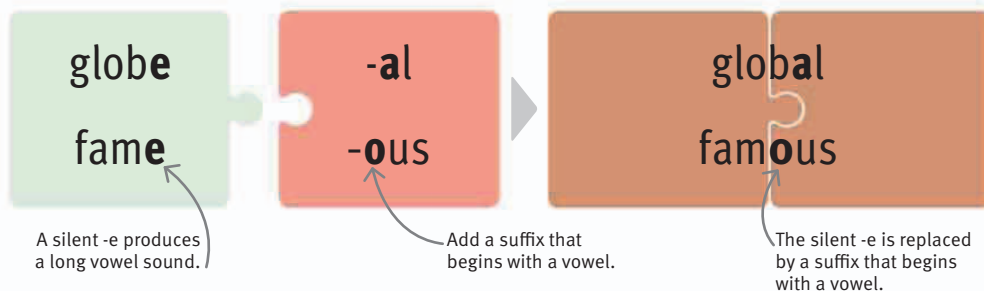
Root word	Suffix	New word
argue	-ment	argument
awe	-ful	awful
due	-ly	duly
nine	-th	ninth
true	-ly	truly
whole	-ly	wholly
wise	-dom	wisdom

△ Exceptions

There are many exceptions to the rules, some of which are listed in this table.

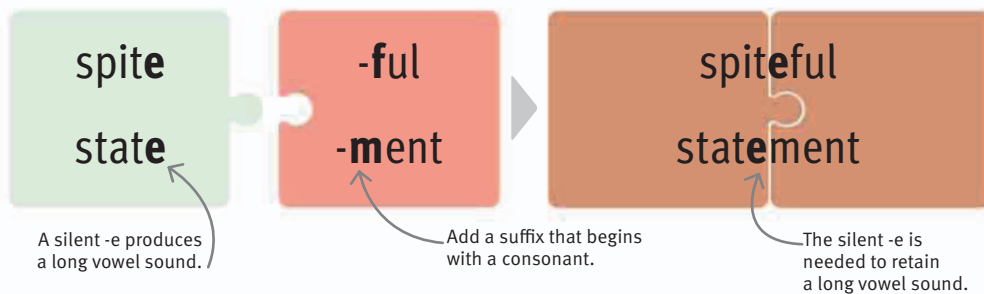
▷ Rule 1

If a word ends in a silent -e, the silent -e is dropped when a suffix beginning with a vowel is added.



▷ Rule 2

If a word ends in a silent -e, the silent -e is kept when a suffix beginning with a consonant is added.



▷ Rule 3

If a word ends in -ce or -ge, the silent -e must be retained with the suffixes -able and -ous.

